

BOOKS FOR ISRAEL

Bookseller's Complaint

To the Editor of THE JEWISH CHRONICLE
Sir,—May I say how much I agree with your correspondent, Mr. Pordes (who wrote last week), regarding the apathy with which a large proportion of the Jewish public is inclined to view the vital question of books for Israel.

As a university bookseller in constant touch with the requirements of students both here and abroad, I find it distressing to see Israel as practically the only country to which British books are not exported. The effect that this will have on cultural relations between our two countries can only be regretted if the situation is allowed to continue.

Books can be exported to Israel against sterling payment, restrictions existing only with regard to the conversion of Israeli currency.

Whether the formation of a book-supply house run as a business proposition, as Mr. Pordes suggests, is the solution, is a matter for discussion. The most important thing at the moment is to appoint a committee to investigate the problem. Action, however, is imperative.

FRANK CASS,
91 Southampton Row, W.C.1.

Timely Reminder

Sir,—Your leading article dealing with the scarcity of English reading material in Israel was a timely reminder.

My suggestion for a solution is an admirable one, and it is to be hoped that it will be brought to the attention of the authorities concerned.

S. SIMONSON,
14 Netherhall Gardens,
Corner Nutley Terrace, N.W.3.

The South Essex Orphan Aid Society held its first dinner and ball recently at the Porchester Hall; £1,050 was raised.

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THE PERSISTENT QUESTIONER

Liberal Judaism and "Noachism"

To the Editor of THE JEWISH CHRONICLE

Sir,—In my article in the "Persistent Questioner" series (which elicited Rabbi Petuchowski's comment in your issue of November 20), I referred very briefly to three features of Orthodox Judaism which I could not accept. Suspecting that many "persistent questioners" found themselves in a similar position, I felt it my duty to draw attention to the existence of a form of Judaism—Liberal Judaism—which is "free from these features."

One of these I labelled "nationalism," meaning thereby that attitude which envisages and approves the permanent confinement of Judaism within a limited national or racial framework. Of this I instanced several symptoms, including what I termed "Noachism." Since Rabbi Petuchowski does not question my instances his objection to this one does not invalidate my thesis. Nevertheless, I do not think that his objection is altogether justified.

"Noachism" certainly has a positive side, and from a historical point of view Rabbi Petuchowski is probably right in insisting it. It implies a tolerance which stands in favourable contrast with the religious exclusivism of Pauline Christianity. At the same time it shows some concern for the spiritual and moral well-being of non-Jews. My point is that it does not show nearly enough. That is its negative side. It falls short of true universalism. It therefore seemed an appropriate and convenient term with which to describe a certain phenomenon in present-day Orthodox Judaism: the view that Judaism is intended solely for a "priest-people" defined by descent, that its acceptance by non-Jews is neither necessary nor especially to be desired.

and that the "Noachian minimum" is all that is required of them.

That this view has not always been characteristic of Judaism is evident from books like Ruth, from the controversy on the subject between the schools of Hillel and Shammai, and from the great far-reaching measures in Jewish history for proselytising monotheism, which seem to be the prevalent one in modern Orthodoxy. I find it inadequate both because it attaches an importance to descent, which is out of place in a universalistic religion, and because I believe that Judaism has far more to offer to the world than the Noachian minimum (which, in most formulations, involves nothing more than the repudiation of polytheism and the acceptance of the most elementary standards of ordinary human decency).

Liberal Jews believe that Judaism has a positive mission to the world, in terms far exceeding the limits of the Noachian conception. I cannot here discuss its practical implementation; but that this is "under debate" among Liberal Jews shows how concerned they are with it. Such a concern does not question my instances his objection to this one does not invalidate my thesis. Nevertheless, I do not think that his objection is altogether justified.

"Noachism" certainly has a positive side, and from a historical point of view Rabbi Petuchowski is probably right in insisting it. It implies a tolerance which stands in favourable contrast with the religious exclusivism of Pauline Christianity. At the same time it shows some concern for the spiritual and moral well-being of non-Jews. My point is that it does not show nearly enough. That is its negative side. It falls short of true universalism. It therefore seemed an appropriate and convenient term with which to describe a certain phenomenon in present-day Orthodox Judaism: the view that Judaism is intended solely for a "priest-people" defined by descent, that its acceptance by non-Jews is neither necessary nor especially to be desired.

(The Rev.) JOHN D. RAYNER,
42 Beccard Avenue,
London, S.W.16.

MANCHESTER REFORM CONGREGATION

Invitation to Communal Rabbi Declined

To the Editor of THE JEWISH CHRONICLE

Sir,—We were blessed on Sunday to see the opening of our new synagogue, replacing another site the synagogue which was destroyed by enemy action in 1941. On this occasion the Communal Rabbi and the other local ministers were invited to attend, but by common agreement declined.

I quote from THE JEWISH CHRONICLE dated March 8, 1953, when the foundation-stone of our original synagogue was laid. On that occasion Professor Theodore, a very eminent scholar, gave an address from which I extract the following:

"The building... would be a potent, palpable as stone, against the usurpation of intolerant power. It would remind them, at all times, that the most active impulse had been given to the formation of their society, by the bull of excommunication... against a number of their Metropolitan brethren..."

I suggest to you, Sir, that the spirit of those overweening ecclesiastics Jews as much today as it did a hundred years ago, seems to me to be in spite of pogroms, massacres, gas chambers, and the like, we learn nothing; and that in 1953, when Gentile ministers honour us with their presence and good will, our own local congregations cannot do otherwise.

We were fortunate indeed in that the Lord Mayor of Manchester and the Mayor of Salford, Orthodox congregations, were sufficiently broadminded to participate, obviously as Jews, in part of the ceremony, by carrying a Seder and opening the Ark respectively. I submit that these lay readers have set an example which "Orthodox" clergy might well emulate.

Maybe our Rabbi P. Selvin Goldberg's remarks in his sermon that "we pledge ourselves to work on behalf of the whole congregation of Israel and not for any fragment thereof" were re-echoed by the Lord Mayor in his evening's speech when he, too, pleaded for understanding and harmony within the community.

F. B. LISTER,
Chairman, Building Committee,
Manchester Congregation of British Jews,
9 Lancaster Road,
Didsbury, Manchester, 20.

AJEX REMEMBRANCE PARADE

Weary Travellers

To the Editor of THE JEWISH CHRONICLE

Sir,—In reply to your correspondent, Mr. J. J. Cohen, I should like him to examine the matter from the Provincial Council's point of view. Would he care to meet my contingent and see them arrive at 5 o'clock on Sunday morning, after an all-night's travel, or better still, at 5 o'clock on Monday morning, after these two nights in the train; see them tired and weary after two strenuous journeys of about seven hours each, wending their way home from employment in a few hours' time? Surely, after witnessing this he would not complain if they received any preferential treatment at the Empress Hall.

Added to all this, may I inform Mr. Cohen that the cost per member is £2.18.11d. for a special one-day fare Newcastle-London, plus the cost of tea and an evening meal, and the travel to the Empress Hall and the return to King's Cross. But for the continued journey, they would have to find an extra nine shillings for lunch—the amount charged to us by the caterers.

My congratulations, Diamond on his reply and his explanation of his allocation of seats, it being the fairest and most equitable method that I know of.

M. GATNER,
Chairman, The AJEX,
Newcastle upon Tyne. ALEX.
17 Holderness Road,
North Heaton,
Newcastle upon Tyne.

Proper Reunion Urged

Sir,—Year after year the old controversy of the ex-Servicemen and women's parade has been thrust upon us. Please, I suggest, may we look at this thing sensibly and constructively. I will grant that 3,000 is a poor turnout, and I am willing to be told that the parade must go on. But why must we continue to thrust our separateness upon our former brothers in arms of different, and varying, religious persuasions? By all means have your rally at the Empress Hall, but please, oh please, make it a reunion of ex-Servicemen and women, and not an anemic cabaret. Give us a "rally in its proper sense" and the journey will become worth while.

247 Lee Lane,
Horwich, Lancs.
J. L. BERNSTEIN.

Bemedalled Onlookers

Sir,—Mr. G. Joseph touches on an important point when he says (in your issue of last week) "While the parade was in progress I saw very many Jewish ex-Servicemen standing by looking on (wearing their medals). How little of dignity was added to the scene by these people—Londoners for sure: provincials would hardly travel so far to effect so little."

True to the vaunted Jewish tradition of individualism, he came to drape their medals over the back-side rails of Whitehall, rather than march with their comrades. If they did it for a bit of self-glorification, then indeed, there was something in it. If any of them should happen to read this, perhaps they will swallow their pride next time and share in the act of rededication, in homage to those who do not march because they are no more.

A. BERNARD LYONS,
Chairman, AJEX, Willsons Branch,
205 Fordwych Road, N.W.2.

KEREN HATORAH GRANTS

At a recent meeting of the Keren Hatorah Committee, grants were made to religious and educational institutions in London, Leeds, Gateshead, Israel, and Farnham.

A grant of £400 was also given recently to the Yeshoda Hatorah School for the establishment of a new branch in North-West London.

66 Chandos Avenue,
Whitestone, N.20.

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YESHIVA AND UNIVERSITY

A "Hybrid" Institution

To the Editor of THE JEWISH CHRONICLE

Sir,—Professor Yoffey gives an interesting account in his article (published recently) of the great contributions of the yeshiva to Jewish learning and culture during the last two millennia; but he is tantalisingly brief about the detailed plans of the Yeshiva-University, which the Mizrahi plan to establish in Israel and of which Professor Yoffey is one of the chief sponsors in this country. There may well be a need for another yeshiva in Israel to supply well-trained rabbis and to produce scholarly laymen. There is certainly an urgent need to expand and strengthen the work of the main institutes of higher learning in Israel, namely, the Hebrew University, the Technion, and the Weizmann Institute. But I am not quite clear why we need the hybrid institution, the Yeshiva-University.

Such an institution to be a university dominated by a school of religious belief. If this is an accurate definition, then the notion of a Yeshiva-University is neither new nor peculiarly Jewish. Oxford and Cambridge in the first half of the nineteenth century were clearly belonged to this category. They were controlled by the Anglican faith and they excluded dissenters, Jew, Catholic and other. But they continued on these lines they would by now have degenerated into insignificant seminaries, but after they had been radically reformed on secular lines they became the great centres of learning which we admire today.

King's College, London, was founded by the Anglican interest as a sort of Yeshiva-University, a counterbalance to the influence of the "pagan" University College. I know little of the early history of King's, but when I was a student and teacher there the yeshiva was represented by a Faculty of Theology, a Chapel, and a Dean, and a college rule forbidding lectures before 10 a.m. to enable students to attend Chapel, but the rest of the work of the college was entirely free from religious influence or restraint.

I gather from my reading that the Yeshiva-University is to be a university of the type of King's, but with a different emphasis. It is to be a university of the type of King's, but with a different emphasis. It is to be a university of the type of King's, but with a different emphasis.

I thought that it was now generally taken for granted that the work of the universities can flourish only in an atmosphere of academic freedom, the only restriction on the work of the staff being that they must pursue truth as they see it. They cannot do so if the governing body are already in possession of the truth in a revealed form. If they would explain to us how academic freedom is compatible with the notion of Yeshiva-University (Professor) SAMSON WRIGHT,
Department of Physiology,
Middlesex Hospital Medical School,
W.1.

HOME FOR INCURABLES

To the Editor of THE JEWISH CHRONICLE

Sir,—While sympathising with your correspondent's recent remarks regarding the Jewish Home for Incapacitated, I wish to draw the attention of Jewish readers to a number of Jewish incurables who are permanently in the incurables of the Northern Group Hospitals (Highlands, Wincanton Hill, N.22) with whom I am in regular contact. The position of these people is compared with those in the "Home for Incapacitated" by the community in general. (Mrs.) REKA MORRIS,
56 Chandos Avenue,
Whitestone, N.20.

INTERMARRIAGE PROBLEM

Marriage Bureau Needed

To the Editor of THE JEWISH CHRONICLE

Sir,—I have read for the past few weeks the letters on intermarriage problems which have been very interesting.

All I want to say is there should be a non-profit-making Jewish marriage bureau.

There are plenty of clubs for those aged 18 to 25 years, but what about those over 25 years of age? There are plenty of them who feel out of place when they visit clubs and find mostly teenagers and persons in their early twenties.

I know that the Maccabi Club at Compton Gardens has started one night a week for the over-25s, but the majority who attend are married. It would be a very good thing if the majority of clubs gave those over 25 years of age a chance. It is very easy for some people to think that it is simple for women not to intermarry, but there is certainly no excuse for a man to do so with so many Jewish girls about.

(Miss) S. BROWN,
51 Reynolds House, E.2.

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RIGHT IS MIGHT

Professor Roth on the Moral Issue

To the Editor of THE JEWISH CHRONICLE

Sir,—Problems of morals are notoriously complicated, and I have no wish to add to the difficulties raised by what is now called the Qibya incident. Dr. Cohen's summing-up of these, the Israelis, he says, are censurable, but most of the censurers should have remained silent.

So far so good. Two of the factors involved (the Israelis on the one hand and the rest of the world on the other) have been satisfactorily dealt with. But there are other factors to be considered as well. There is, for example, the religion, or the system of thought, called Judaism. And there are, too, the non-Jews, Jews considered either in themselves or in so far as they represent, or profess, Judaism. The problem is whether either Judaism or Jewry can acquiesce in this incident. It is the type of action which we have been accustomed to say that Judaism taught the world to condemn and from which Jewry has itself so often suffered. If we identify ourselves with it now or condemn its perpetrators, where will Jewry be the next time if it is the victim; and what will Jews be able to say the next time Judaism is attacked?

Shall we be able to say that we do not do to others what we do not wish others to do to us? That the *lex talionis* is not Jewish; that we abhor the spilling of blood and the taking of life; that we are commanded in the Pentateuch to care for the non-Jew ("love the stranger"), as was noted by the rabbis of another day, thirty-six times? Shall we still be able to say that the institution of properly constituted courts for the investigation of crime is one of the fundamental moral requirements of Judaism; that the Torah bans private revenge and insists on due process of law; that fathers should not be killed for the sins of children nor children for the sins of their fathers, but each man should suffer for his own acts; that responsibility before God and man is in Jewish eyes personal?

The real tragedy is, of course, for the Israelis. And it does not lie in the political deterioration of their boys' souls. What manner of men are these who could contrive this action, or what persons could carry it out? And what manner of men are they who, arrogantly dismissing the moral issue, because themselves and us with their *realpolitik*! When terrorism is used as an instrument of policy the worst consequences fall on those who use it.

And here I should refer again to Dr. Cohen's letter. Dr. Cohen says that we have no right to object to the "dramatic and honourable" institution, can we carry out against honest and liberal-minded men, even of other religions and types of thought, who on the grounds taught by Judaism, recognise an Israeli action for what it is?

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